

Destined to deliver: Hardik was a key figure in the Indian teams that won bronze medals at both the Tokyo and Paris Olympics. GETTY IMAGES

KEEPING UP A LEGACY

India's hockey story is not just about medals but also about families who carried the game forward. From Dhyan Chand, his brother Roop Singh and son Ashok Kumar, to Lawrie Fernandes and his daughter Lorraine, generations have worn the Indian jersey with pride. The latest link is **Hardik Singh**, whose uncle and aunt once did the same.

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One of Hardik Singh's foundational memories as vice-captain of the Indian men's team dates back to 2004, when India played Pakistan in the Amritsar

leg of the 'Dosti Series' — a seven-match competition between the two nations.

What stands out for Hardik is not watching from the stands of the Guru Nanak Dev Stadium but how close he got to the action. "What I remember is that at half-time, my *chacha* took me down to the

